interface (CLI), you can build apps with the tools you're comfortable with on any platform.

As a result, whether you build using Visual Studio or the .NET CLI, the same tools are being used under the hood. Visual Studio provides an additional graphical user interface (GUI), functionality, and wrappers for building your app, but it (mostly) executes the same commands as the .NET CLI behind the scenes.

As a refresher, you've used four main .NET CLI commands so far to build your apps:

- `dotnet new`—Creates an ASP.NET Core application from a template
- `dotnet restore`—Downloads and installs any referenced NuGet packages for your project
- `dotnet build`—Compiles and builds your project
- `dotnet run`—Executes your app so you can send requests to it

If you've ever built a .NET application, whether it's a legacy ASP.NET app or a .NET Framework console app, you'll know that the output of the build process is written to the bin folder by default. The same is true for ASP.NET Core applications.

If your project compiles successfully when you call `dotnet build`, the .NET CLI writes the artifacts to a bin folder in your project's directory. Inside this bin folder are several files required to run your app, including a .dll file that contains the code for your application. Figure 27.2 shows the output of the bin folder for a basic ASP.NET Core application.